

Wartime Recap: Battle of Allatoona (Oct. 5, 1864)

Amy Barnes

Location: Bartow County, Georgia

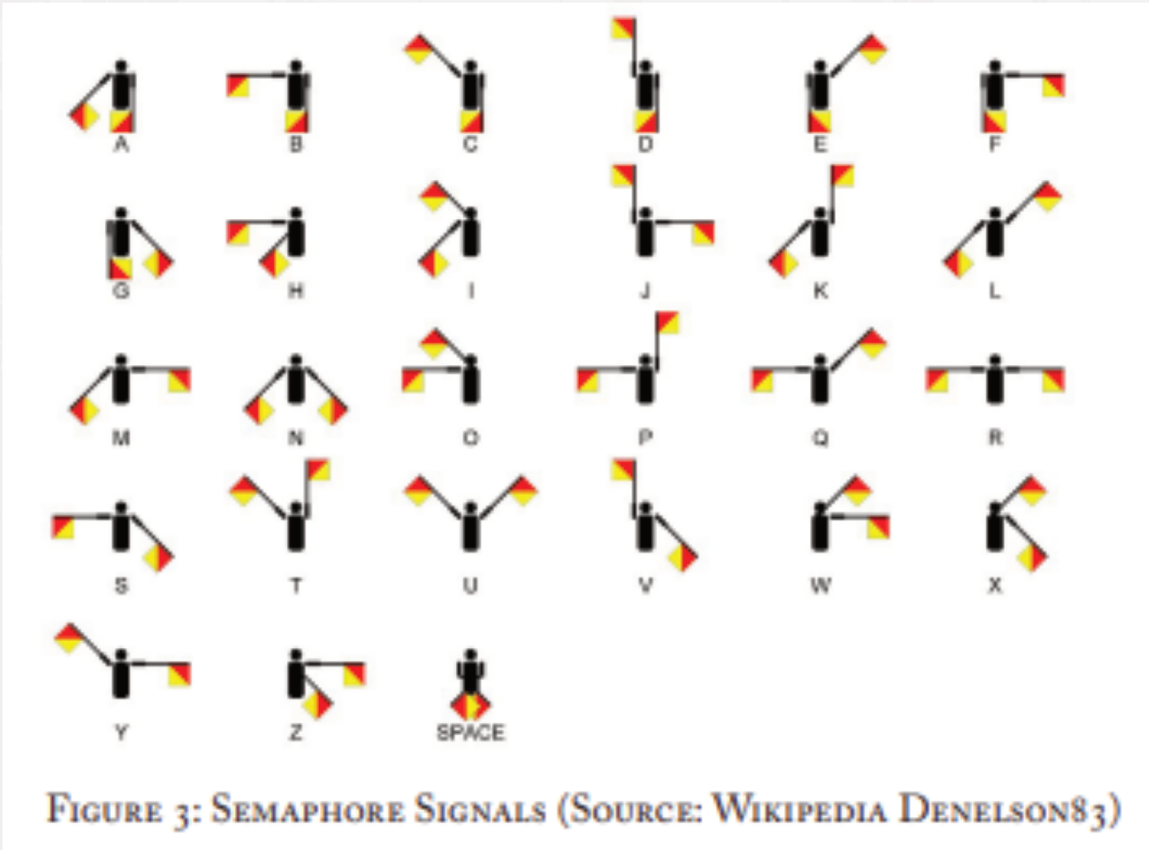
Commanders:
Union: Maj. Gen. William T. Sherman
Confederate: Maj. Gen. Samuel G. French

Involved & Casualties:
Union: 2,025 fought 706 died
Confederate: 3,276 fought 897 died

Outcome: Union victory

Significance: This battle involved the now-famous order to "Hold the Fort" which became the inspiration for one of the most famous hymns. The "wig-wag" flagging system used to convey the order became pivotal as it sped up long-distance communication. "Shadow Game." By Ron Soodalter - 6/21/2026, <https://historynet.com/shadow-game/>

Signal flag communication typically involved raising and lowering flags bearing specific signals, and this could take as long as several minutes for a basic message to be conveyed, usually by ship if flags were used. Robert Etheredge and Russell Bourne. "A Brief History of Signal Flags." Accessed June 21, 2026. <https://mvsigflags.com/assets/data/FlagHistory2.pdf>



Source for Statistics at top:
Kennedy, Frances H., ed. (1998). The Civil War Battlefield Guide (Kindle) (2nd ed.). Boston, MA: Houghton Mifflin Co. ISBN 0-395-74012-6. Retrieved June 21, 2026.